Spirit Shiker's



MARKETING MAP

By Bo Inman

THE WORLD OF SPIRIT STRIKER



01 / THE MARKETING MAP

What Spirit Striker is

Spirit Striker. The scheme and capture of the product and the app we are going to create. I'm merging these ideas together: the innovator, the lizard, the Spirit Striker realm, and the strike, the thunder rolling across the digital and physical landscape.

This book is about how to market Spirit Striker. But first, what is Spirit Striker? For me, it is the awareness of the spirit. Spirit, intuition, ideas and imagination. The willingness to take action and try new things. It is about innovators, designers, engineers and creators bringing something into the world.

There is a shamanic aspect to it: tapping into that spirit realm, being energised, and letting that energy flow through you. Connection, longing and belonging together. I want to concentrate that into one core idea and build from there.

The Spirit Striker logo is the seed. It is the idea I have committed to explore. The world has a map, Toga. There are places to explore, like Pyramid Island. There are the characters: Moe, Toe, Eve, Evan, Sage, Box and Peak. Seven of them. There are games, books, masks and drawings. There is the app I want to create, with its capture wheel and stamp making.

At first, those might sound like separate things. But it is a world you dive into. The app can hold that experience together. There can be updates, a feed, things to listen to, things to make, and a map that tells you when an event is happening. I want it to curate an experience you do not get anywhere else.

I want to centre the content around me first. Eventually, people could make their own content, but we are not there yet. First, I need to make something they can enter and experience. The app should be free. What I want to sell is access to the core idea and a deeper experience of becoming a Spirit Striker.

I want you to listen with an exploratory mind. We are going through the problems and issues of unleashing Spirit Striker and capturing the imaginations of maybe five people, maybe a million. Who knows how many are out there? The book will grow with the world.

THE DISTRIBUTION PROBLEM



The distribution problem

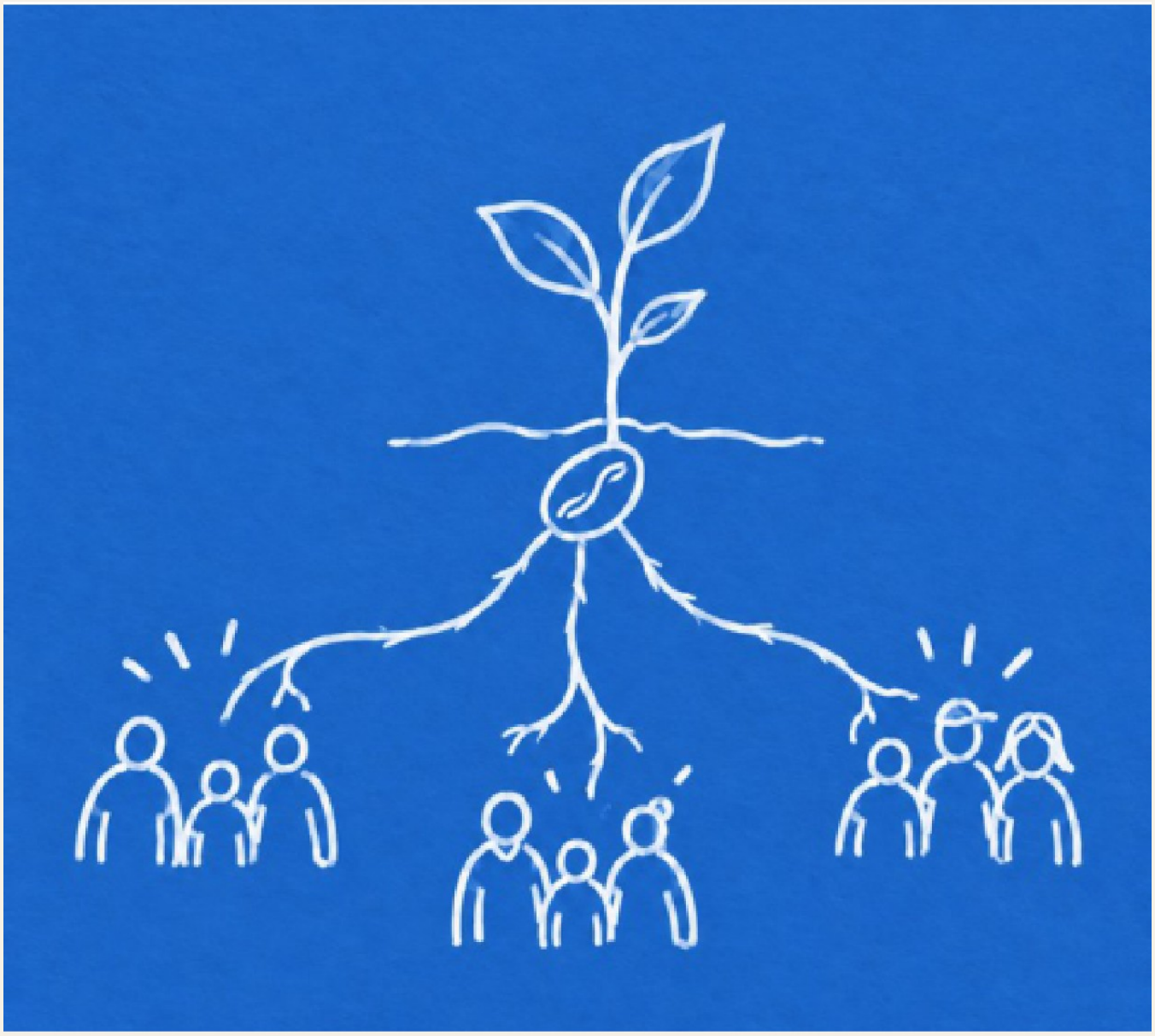
I have had this experience of going through the internet and finding conflicting ideas. Someone tells you to pick a niche. Someone else tells you not to make the product first. I have struggled to make a newsletter, and I see the issue: it is difficult to bring your idea together and have an impact.

Making the app does not solve the distribution problem. The hardest thing, and what I see as the greatest moat, is your audience. The scheme is not just making an app anymore. How do you get people into the experience?

For me, Spirit Striker is a cultural engineering project. We have the capture wheel, stamp making, games, books and masks to explore. There is a world behind those things. The challenge is to give people a way into that world, and a reason to bring somebody else with them.

There is so much noise: products, services, ideas and things on the internet. I need to think about distribution, creativity, shareability and remarkable behaviour. I need to make something people can experience, then see what they actually do with it.

THE CORE IDEA



The core stays in the centre.

The core idea is the seed

The advice to just start with a niche did not help me. It added confusion. A small bubble, a small worldview: go after a small problem. But the way I am thinking about it is to centralise the core idea closest to you.

If somebody has been painting their whole life, painting might be the closest idea to them. For me, it is Spirit Striker. I can concentrate my energy into that one focus and explore different things within it.

The niche is not the product. In the way I am using the word, the niche is the core idea. It can be small or broad. You start there. Then you make a product and put a few people in front of it. Let them find their way through it without forcing every action.

Think of the seed growing into a tree. Each branch reaches in a different direction. One reaches for sunlight. Another strengthens the tree. The whole tree is doing many things through those smaller branches. That is how I picture the different avenues through a product.

The product is a conduit. It is like a river to where somebody needs to go. The customer is the one moving through it, finding the problem and doing something about it. We make the paths and streams stronger as we learn what helps.

I am obsessed with Spirit Striker, so I pick that one thing and try different things within it. A comic, an app, a game or a tool can become a branch. The core stays in the centre.

WORLD BUILDING



A world-view builder

There is something I did not realise at first. With the product, we are making a worldview. It is world building. The product I am trying to create is a world-view builder.

But you cannot just have world building. What drives it? What does somebody want from that world? That is where the motives come in. I think of them as dimensions: different realms, different ways into an experience.

Somebody already has a worldview when they arrive. There is another part to this: matching the experience to their expectations as accurately as possible over time. A mismatch is one of the failure modes I want to notice during natural product selection.

My idea is that the more relevant matches we make, the more chance there is of getting somebody to the shared edge. We still need to see that happen. What did they expect? What did they experience? Where did it fail to match?

THE SEVEN MOTIVES



The seven motives: the 7S

You direct the conduits toward a problem. The way I am organising those problems is through the motives we have, the seven S's: Strength, Sexual, Safety, Survival, Smarts, Spiritual and Status.

Status is like being the king, being the best at something. Survival is your basic needs. Sexual, in the way I described it here, is reproduction. Smarts is intellect and curiosity.

Strength can be the ability to fight a foe. It can also be overcoming a difficult obstacle within ourselves: the courage and willpower inside you, the spirit to go through something. Safety is another of the seven motives I have named.

Spiritual is that connection with the great spirit, longing and belonging together. Solving, resolving or satisfying one of these motives is how I am looking at what drives somebody toward an experience.

Why did you download the app? Why did you buy the book? Why did you buy the car? There is a reason behind that action. Like asking about a motive: why did somebody do it? We are trying to understand the source of the action.

For Spirit Striker, everything comes back to that centre. We concentrate what we have to satisfy our need or somebody else's need within that realm of a motive. Then we make a conduit, a strike, toward the outer edge.

THE SATISFACTION LOOP



The satisfaction loop

The way I see it, all seven motives follow the same loop. Something satisfying reaches the senses and entices a motive. It captivates attention and gives someone a reason to move toward an experience. Then the experience satisfies the motive, if it actually meets what they wanted.

A satisfying look can be the beginning. Sight, sound, smell, taste and touch can all be part of it. But being drawn toward something and having the motive satisfied are different moments.

Strength. Seeing a difficult challenge can draw someone in. Overcoming it can bring the satisfaction of capability, courage or willpower.

Sexual. Attraction can begin through the senses. A date, mutual connection and, when both people want it, sex can be experiences that satisfy the desire. Attraction alone is not the whole experience.

Safety. A shield, shelter or reassuring presence can suggest protection. Experiencing that protection is what meets the need.

Survival. The sight and smell of food can entice hunger. Eating the food can satisfy it.

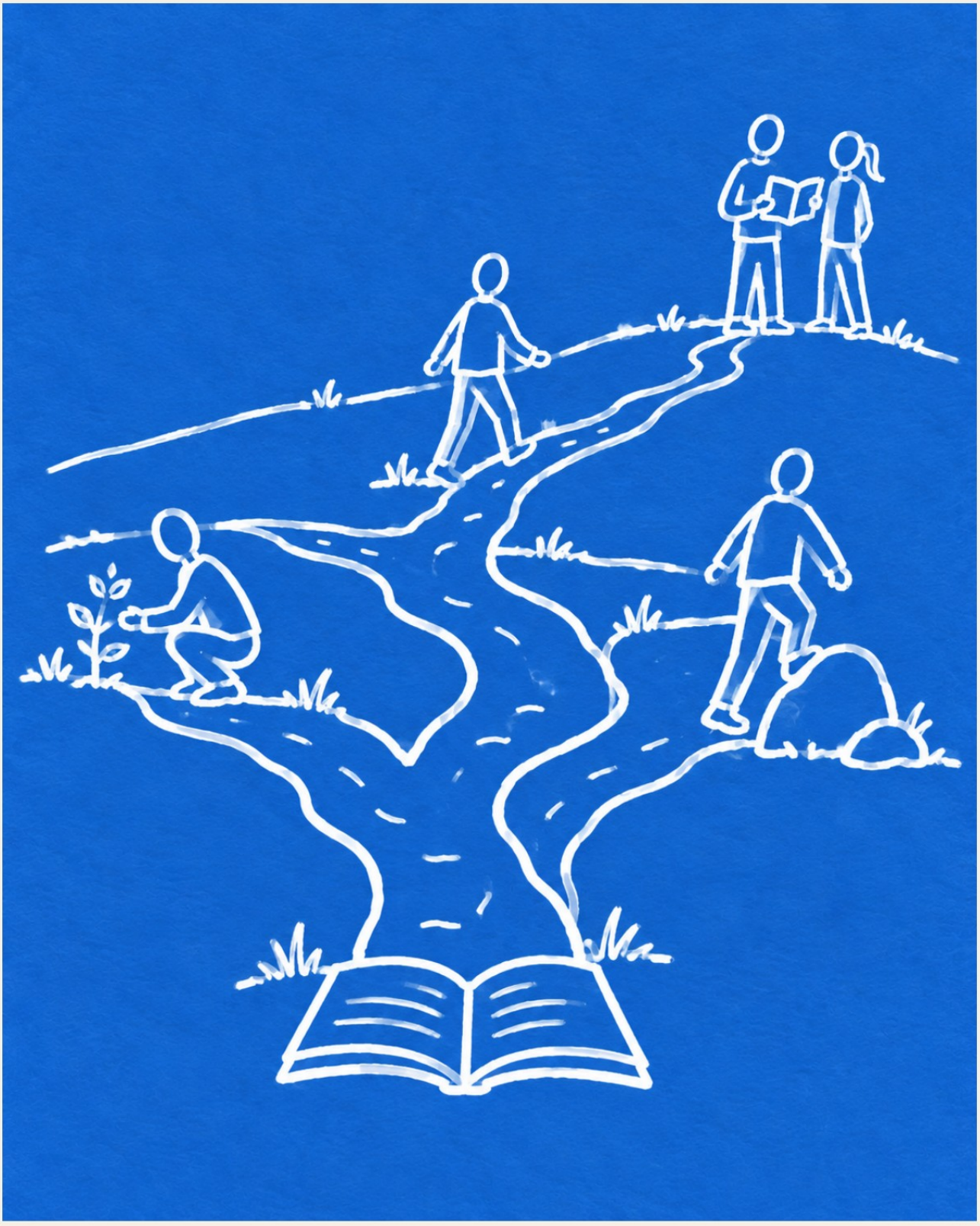
Smarts. An interesting question can excite curiosity. Exploring it, understanding it or finding an answer can satisfy that curiosity.

Spiritual. An image, sound or place can draw someone toward connection and belonging. Taking part and experiencing that connection can bring satisfaction.

Status. A trophy or recognition can make achievement appealing. Earning recognition can satisfy that motive.

So I want to connect the satisfying senses with the actual satisfaction. The motive is met for that moment. It can return later. Then the question is whether the experience leaves a mark somebody wants to carry to another person.

NATURAL PRODUCT SELECTION



Natural product selection

Natural product selection is what I call allowing the product to grow by cutting, removing and adding things over time. Keep exploring within the core idea. Put people in front of the product and notice where they go.

That is where I want to put my awareness. If I go on tour or spend money on exposure, I want that exposure to bring people into this part of the experience. That is where I can identify who connects with it and what they are trying to do.

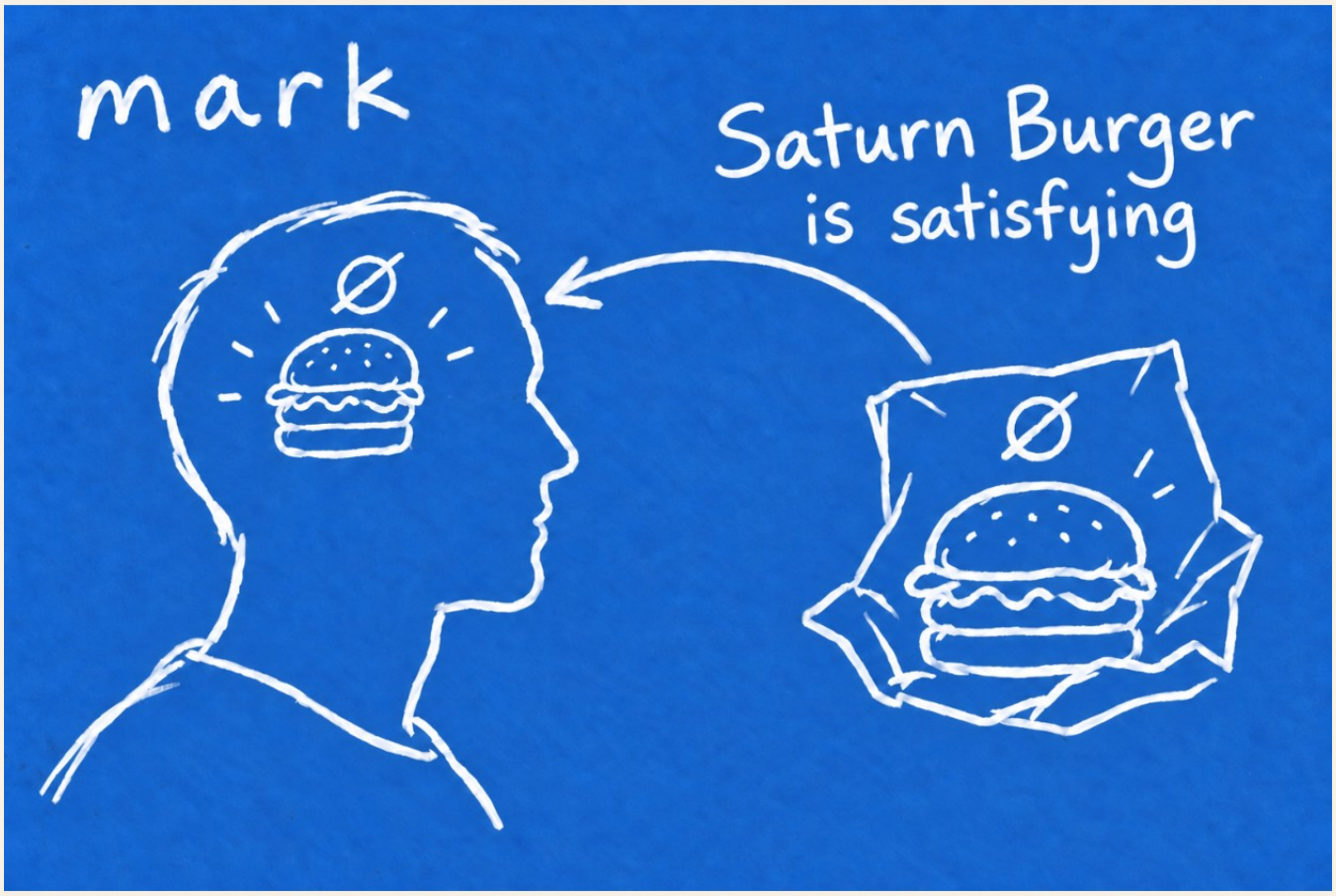
Media gives you a lot to explore. With a comic book or an app, there are only so many pages somebody can get through, and only so many ideas they can absorb. The person is moving through the experience, finding what matters to them.

I want to bring them toward the sharing edge when they are getting close to what they wanted, or have achieved it. If I ask them to share too early, they may not have had the experience yet. Too late, and they may have moved on. The circles in my drawings have a timing element.

There can be too much resistance. There can also be so little involvement that the experience does not feel satisfying. The timing and the experience need to work together. I want to understand when someone is ready for the next step.

MARK

What makes that mark stay in someone's head?



Mark: why do we remember?

Have you ever wondered why you remember McDonald's, Toyota, Xbox or NVIDIA? You see a name, a shape or a symbol, and you already have an idea of what it means. How did that happen?

Look at big brands and movements. People gather around a mark, recognise it and carry it into the world. But what makes that mark stay in someone's head? And how does it become something they want to share?

Think of a mark inside your head, like a thought. Think of marking on a wall. Now think of marketing through those markings: an image, an idea, a thought, a sound or a smell that somebody encounters.

Imagine a person sees a burger with a logo. The burger and the mark outside them have a recognizable image inside their head. In our example, it is Saturn Burger.

The mark can be satisfying. If it looks good, that first impression can already have a satisfying aspect. I did not realise that at first. "Saturn Burger is satisfying." That first impression is part of the mark.

What is in the physical world needs to match what the person understands in their head. They see the mark and form an expectation. Then there is the experience itself.

EXPERIENCE



They have eaten it and experienced it.

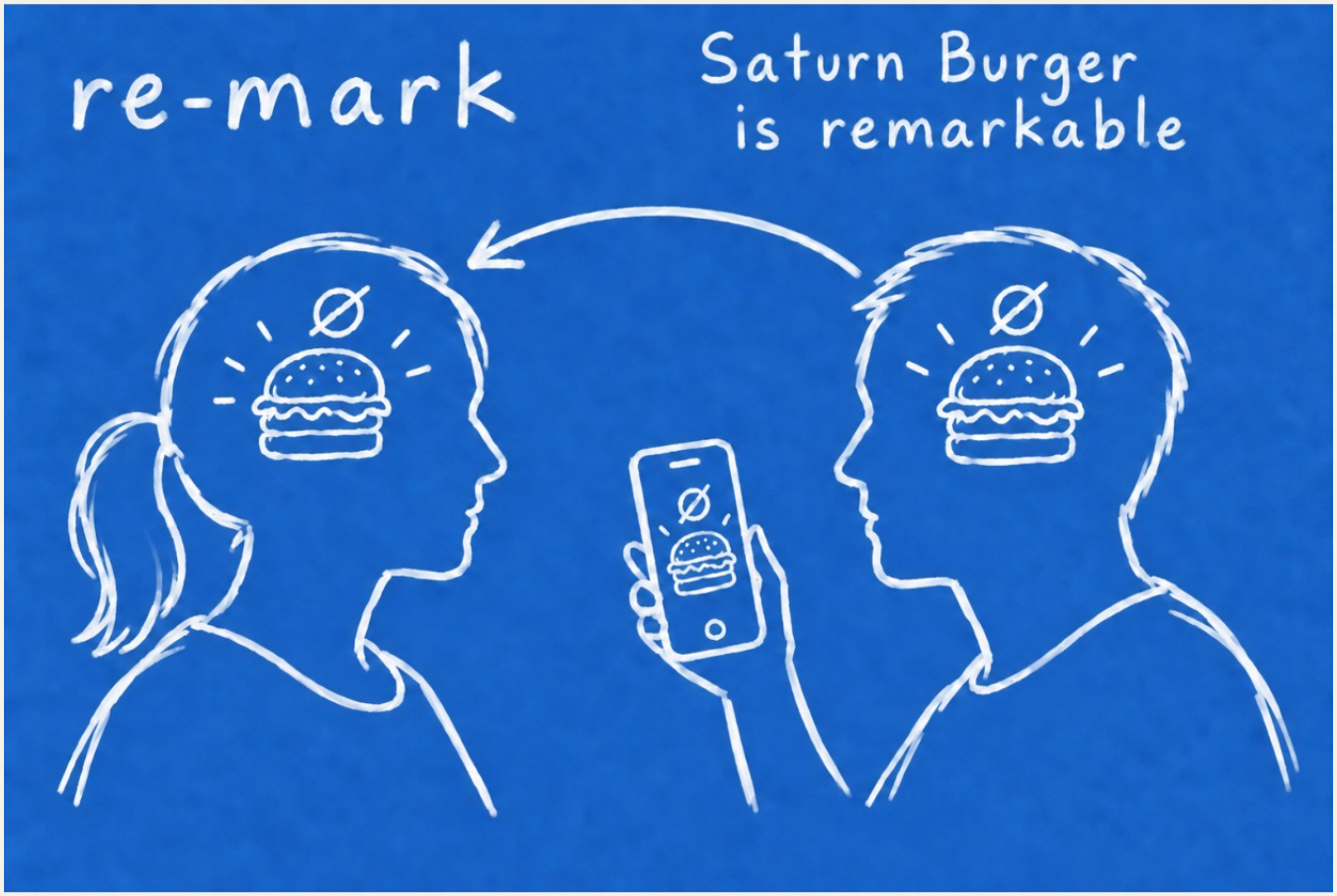
Experience: satisfy the motive

There is another part: the person actually experiences it. They eat the burger. In this example, the motive is survival, and eating meets their hunger.

That is the satisfaction behind the recommendation I want to show. It is not only that the burger looked good. They have eaten it and experienced it. The mark now connects with that experience.

That same question comes back to Spirit Striker. What does someone actually experience? What have they made, understood or taken part in? What motive has that experience satisfied? I want to get someone to the shared edge through something that has happened for them.

RE-MARK



They carry the mark outward again.

Re-mark: carrying the experience again

A mark, then re-mark. The reproduction of doing it again and again.

The person has the experience inside their head. Then they share it with a friend through their phone, through words, through visuals or through another medium. That is the remarkable behaviour I want to produce. They carry the mark outward again.

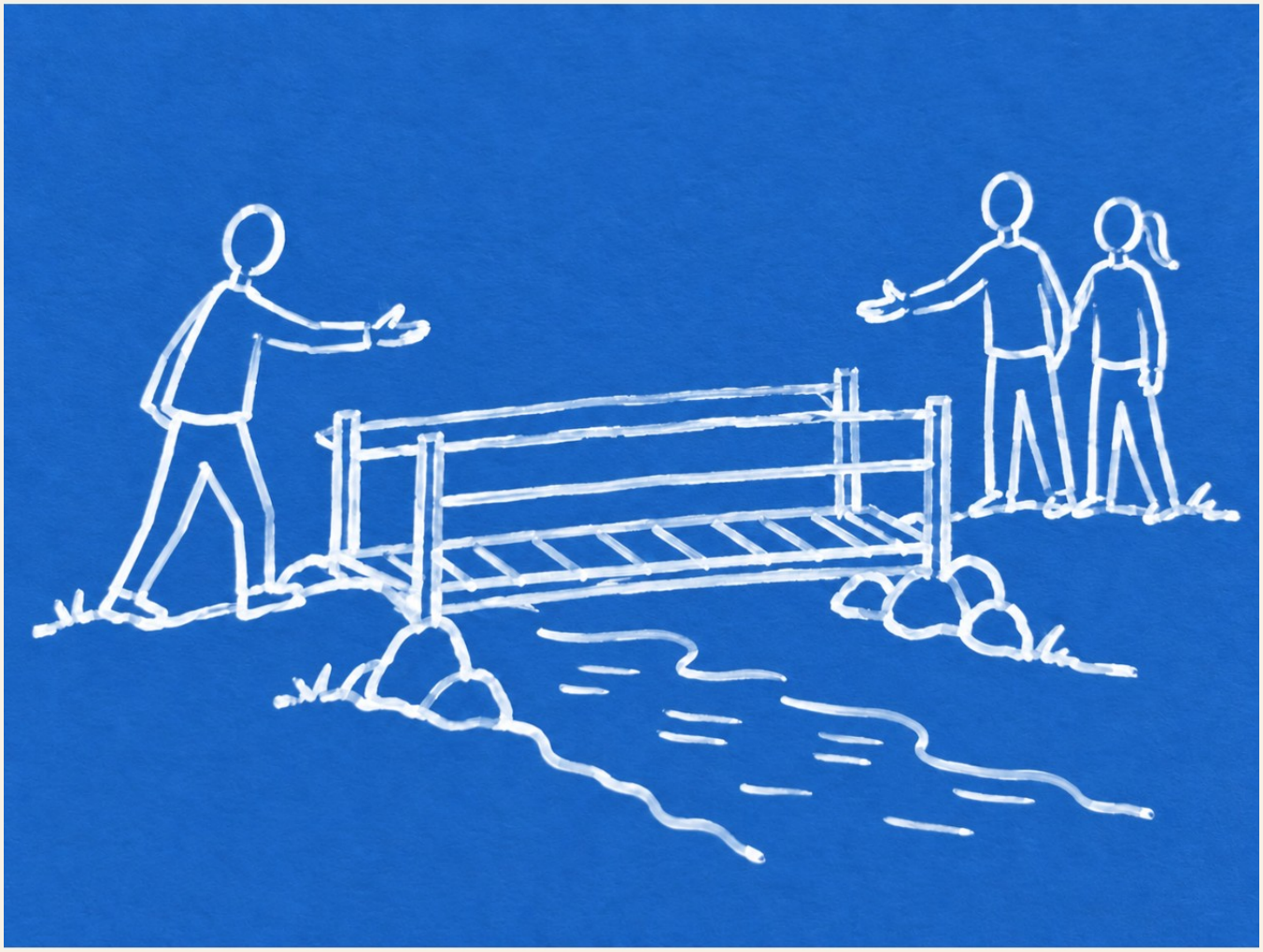
"Saturn Burger is remarkable." Now someone else encounters it. The shared edge enters another worldview. Imagine the different bubbles and possibilities. One person reaches the edge of their bubble and brings something into another bubble.

It changes with each individual experience. The marks are theirs: what they remember, the thoughts they have, and how the experience brought them closer to something they wanted. That is why I call it re-marking.

Someone sharing because they truly enjoyed something is the part I care about. You can get somebody to buy and they may never share the product. The voluntary share tells me that they want to carry the experience to somebody else.

I call the next part re-mark intuition. I want to lower the resistance to sharing, so it becomes intuitive to carry something across. The person can show it, say it, call somebody or send it. The people within their group can do the same.

TRUST AND THE CROSSING



Change the experience, re-mark the situation.

Trust is a crossing

I picture trust as a crossing, like a bridge or a train trestle. The Christian cross gives me another image: the crossing and the grounding underneath it. The intuitive part is the approach that makes the crossing feel possible.

There is a trust between me and you. There can also be trust within a group. The experience and the next action become clear enough that somebody feels ready to buy, support or share.

I want to lower the resistance and conflict so buying together feels intuitive. There is an emotional part to that: "I did not need all that effort to do this." With Spirit Striker, that brings us toward the merge buy.

When the experience misses

A bad experience can reach the sharing edge too. Somebody can tell another person about what went wrong. That is exposure, but it can become a bad reputation. Farther along, there may not be enough trust to buy.

I want to make those situations right. Change the experience, re-mark the situation, and give the person a reason to see it differently. That is the part of the path where a failure can tell me what needs to improve.

Matching someone's worldview is part of this. If the experience misses their expectation, I need to notice it. It is still part of natural product selection, of finding where the product fits. I want to make those matches more accurately over time.

MERGE BUYING



Merge buying

We need to buy things to survive. We might buy for status, or for another motive. So what is my solution for monetising Spirit Striker? What is the merge buy?

It is a group effort to reduce the price of something together, in a cohort. Seven people put in seven dollars each. Together, that is forty-nine dollars. Instead of one person paying forty-nine dollars, those seven people can each contribute seven dollars to the group offer.

The total is still forty-nine dollars. The idea is that the offer gives an added benefit to those individuals while they help bring the group together. That is how I want to build distribution into the buying process.

If somebody does not have a group, the app could have its own network of people. Someone says, "I want to buy this." Other people join the offer, and the group works together to fill the places. You can use the app freely while you find people to buy with.

I call it merge buying because we bring the purchase together. People keep their own accounts. The group gives them a way to reduce the bill together and unlock access. It could become a special account or an upgraded experience.

There are different ways it could work: a one-time offer, annual access or a subscription. The timing of payment and the moment access unlocks need to be worked out. The idea is that people can see who is joining them and what they are helping to fund.

I want that to build trust and accountability. More people using something together could give them more reason to return. The next upgrade could use a merge buy again, with a larger group goal or a deeper experience.

But collecting forty-nine dollars does not mean the business is profitable. It means we have made some money. The next question is what it costs to deliver, and what the group wants enough to buy next. That is where the larger offer comes into the plan.

THE CAPTURE WHEEL



The wheel starts with a reaction.

13 / THE MARKETING MAP

The app as the marketing vessel

The app has not been finished. I want it to have the capture wheel, a stamp-making tool, a game and a feed. I want to keep building and allow the form to develop as people use it.

The wheel starts with a reaction. Someone watches or listens to something, then chooses a hue, a colour, a shape or a theme. They make a Spirit Striker stamp from that response.

The stamp can become a message, a GIF or something used in a card game. It can be kept or shared with somebody else. There can be a progression element as people take part.

That is where the product can become the marketing vessel. Someone has made something from an experience. They send it to another person, and that person has a way into Spirit Striker.

The feed, listening, updates and the map can give people a reason to come back. The content starts with me. Eventually, it can spread into more participation from the users, different people and different cultures.

I keep scheming, keep building and keep making the product first. I need something real to put in front of people. I struggle to make a sale because I understand how high the bar can feel, how much it takes to make something extraordinary.

THE FIRST OFFERING



The execution gap and attention

This has given me the most comprehensive review of my idea of marketing, product creation and selling something so far. But it still does not solve the execution of going to people and selling something.

I still do not really have a product to sell. I do not yet have the vehicle to draw people and that free energy toward me. By free energy, I mean the attention I could attract and direct toward the work.

The exchange I am thinking about is offering something for free and asking for attention in return. I want to make that attention useful: bring someone into Spirit Striker, give them an experience, and let them find what matters to them.

That is the next thing to execute. The product needs to be there for somebody to experience. The invitation needs to bring them to it. Then I can see whether the experience reaches the shared edge and whether there is something they want to buy together.

RETURN TO THE SOURCE



The squirrel and the return to the source

I am out here in nature, and there is a squirrel. Think about the acorns squirrels put away. Some of the acorns they do not eat can grow into trees that make more acorns. There is a relationship there, a small action that can have a future beyond the moment.

That is the image I am thinking about for our work. You put things out for free. People pick something up and put it away. Later, it can grow into a memory or a thought. "Oh, that makes sense." They might not even realise it at first.

Someone might get your thing, put it away and come back ten years later: "I need it now." That is why you need to be available. You need to be reliable and there, so people can come back to you.

The conduit comes back to the source, the core idea. That is your thing, your niche, right in the middle. In the way I am using the word, a niche does not have to mean a tiny thing. It could become very big. All the roads lead back to the source.

For Spirit Striker, that is the awareness of the spirit. Spirit, intuition, ideas and imagination. Going big even if it seems small at first. Like the squirrel putting an acorn in the ground and letting it be.

I could leave my original papers here, and you never know whose life they might affect. The images, the drawings, the work we make: somebody can take something from them at a time we do not expect.

There are exciting times ahead, and there can be massive struggles too. People can copy an idea quickly, but the moat I want to build is the ability to create something, immerse myself in it and get people on board.

Keep iterating. Get the momentum. Treat every second somebody spends with the world you share as a precious moment. Attention is valuable. It is something we have to respect.

That is what I want to do with Spirit Striker.

SHARE THE SATISFACTION



SHARE THE SATISFACTION

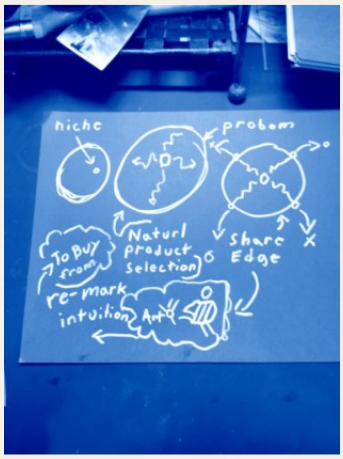
If this experience left a satisfying mark, share it.

The Spirit Strikers invite you to share the satisfaction of reading this map.

Send it to someone who might find something in it. Tell them what stayed with you, in your own words.

That is a re-mark. One remarkable experience can become the beginning of another, carried from person to person, across the world.

THE SEED AND THE SHARING EDGE



THE COMPLETE MAP



01 / Core idea



02 / Sharing edge

The core idea stays at the centre. The sharing edge carries it outward.



03 / Re-mark and trust

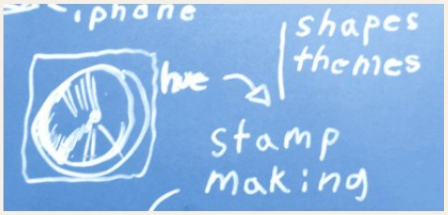
The circles connect the core idea, natural product selection and the sharing edge. The re-mark carries the experience into another person's worldview.

THE CAPTURE WHEEL





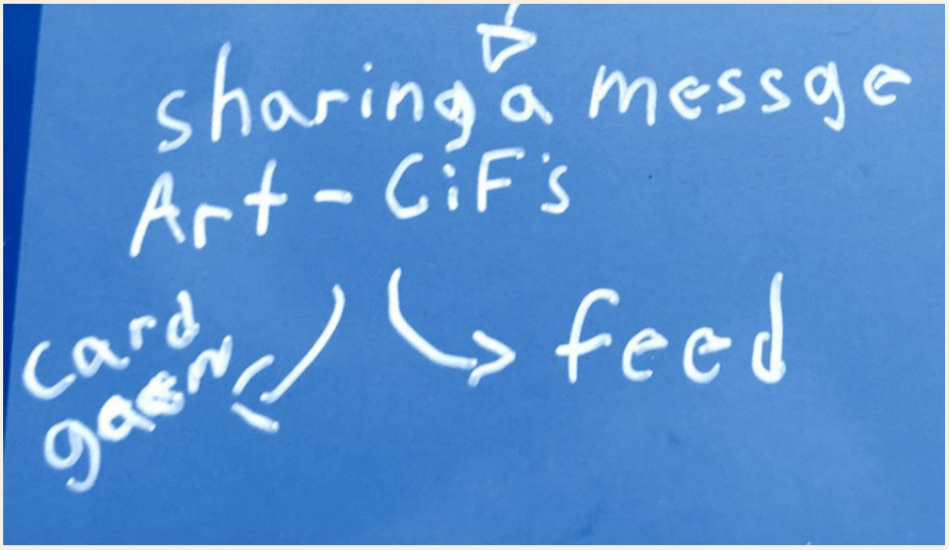
01 / Enter through the app



02 / Hue, shapes and stamps

CAPTURE WHEEL

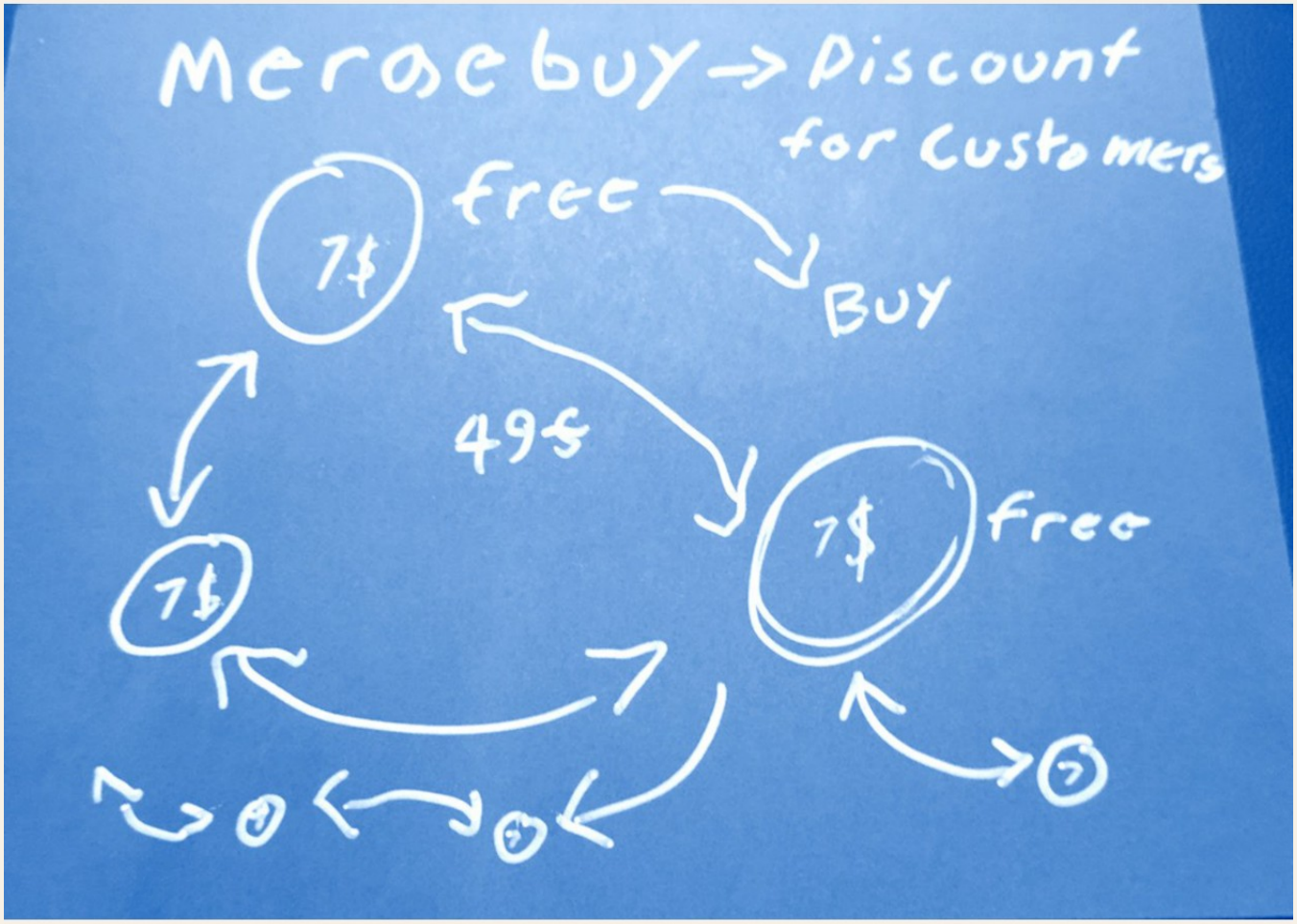
An experience becomes a reaction, then a stamp somebody can keep or share.



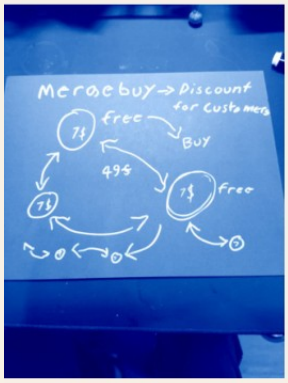
03 / Share a message

The wheel begins with an experience. Hue, shape and theme give a reaction a form. A stamp can be kept or shared as a message, a GIF or a card-game object.

MERGE BUYING



01 / A group contribution becomes one offer



THE GROUP OFFER

Seven contributions of $7 make a $49 group total. Each person keeps a separate account.

The arrows connect the contribution, the group and the purchase.